

BALLROOM

Dance

01

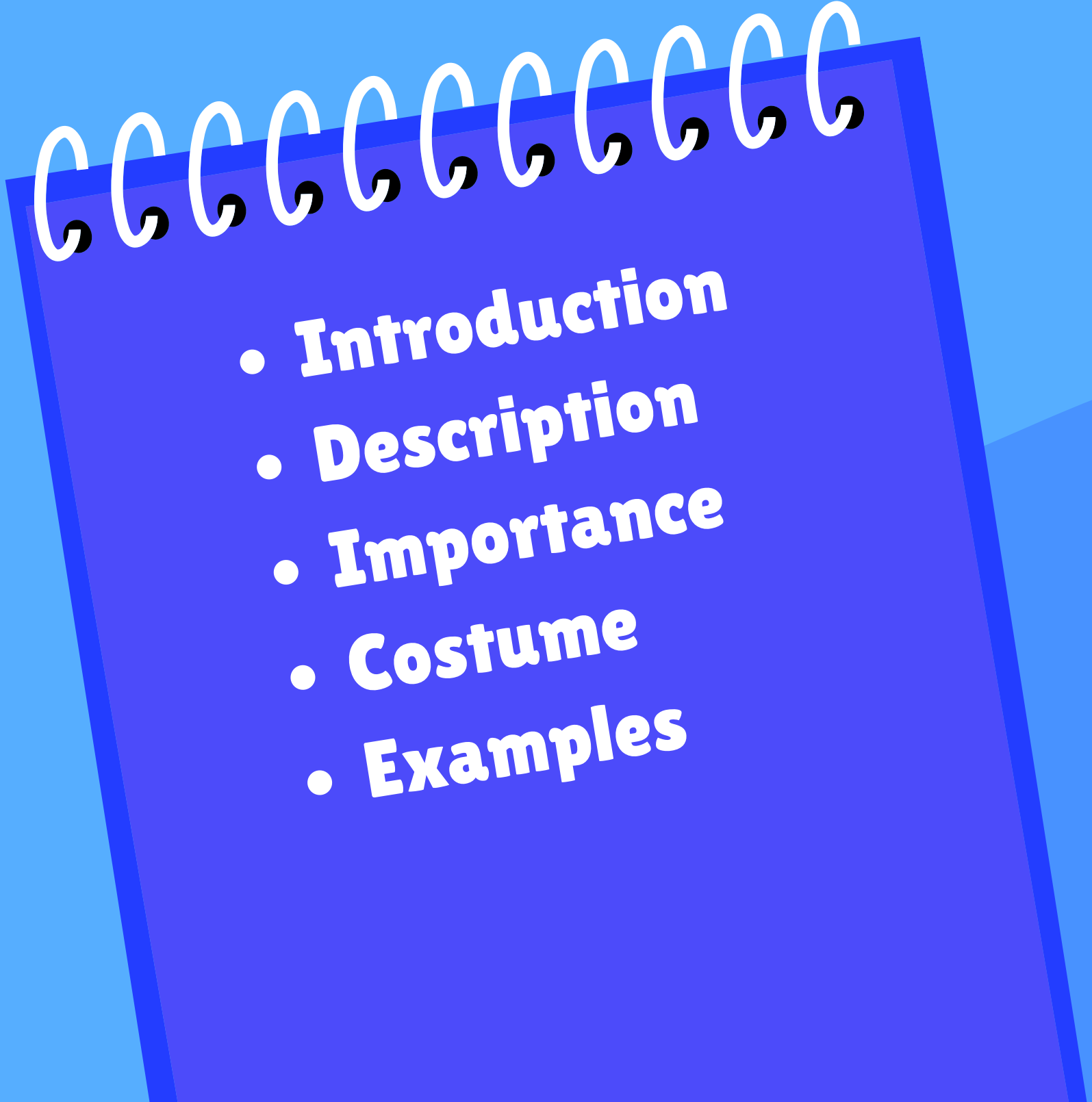
Ballroom

Getting to know the
essentials

G1



**What will be
discussed?**

- 
- **Introduction**
 - **Description**
 - **Importance**
 - **Costume**
 - **Examples**

Introduction

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Type of social dancing, originally practiced in Europe and the United States, that is performed by couples and follows prescribed steps. The tradition was historically distinguished from folk or country dance by its association with the elite social classes and with invitational dance events.

In the 21st century, however, ballroom dance is present in many parts of the world and has practitioners in virtually all segments of society. It is performed in various contexts, including invitational and public dance events, professional dance exhibitions, and formal competitions.



Description

Ballroom dancing is a partnership dance where couples, using step-patterns, move rhythmically, expressing the characteristics of music. Ballroom dancing consists of two styles: the Smooth, or Standard, and the Rhythm, or Latin. The Smooth, Standard style focuses on the elegance, grace and fluidity of movement. Dancers rotate in a counter-clockwise direction, moving around the entire floor. The couple is constantly moving on the dance floor, transitioning from one place to the next in a fixed pattern.

Importance

Ballroom dancing is a fun and engaging activity that offers a wide range of benefits for individuals of all ages and skill levels. Beyond the obvious enjoyment of learning and performing various dance styles, ballroom dancing can significantly impact one's physical, mental, and social well-being. In this article, we will discuss the numerous advantages of participating in ballroom dancing, highlighting the positive effects it can have on your overall health and quality of life.

Physical Benefits:

Improved cardiovascular fitness:

Ballroom dancing provides an excellent cardiovascular workout, helping to improve heart health, stamina, and endurance.

Enhanced flexibility and balance:

Ballroom dancing requires dancers to perform a range of motions, which helps to increase flexibility and improve balance and coordination.

Increased muscle strength and tone:

The various movements and techniques involved in ballroom dancing engage and strengthen different muscle groups, resulting in a more toned and defined physique.

Weight management:

As a form of aerobic exercise, ballroom dancing can contribute to weight loss or maintenance by burning calories and increasing metabolism.



Mental Benefits:

Stress relief:

Dancing provides a fun and enjoyable outlet for releasing stress, allowing participants to unwind and forget their daily worries.

Cognitive function:

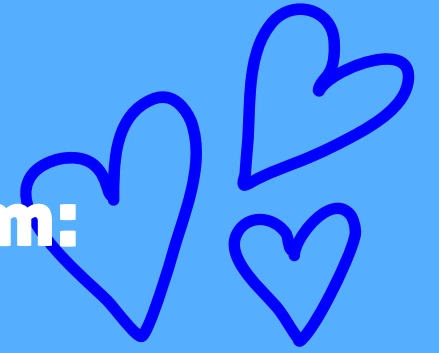
Ballroom dancing requires mental focus, concentration, and memorization, which helps to sharpen cognitive abilities and may reduce the risk of age-related cognitive decline.

Boosts self-confidence and self-esteem:

As dancers progress and master new skills, they often experience increased self-confidence and a greater sense of accomplishment.

Emotional expression:

Ballroom dancing offers a creative outlet for expressing emotions and interpreting music through movement, fostering emotional well-being and personal growth.



Social Benefits:

Improved social skills:

Ballroom dancing requires partner communication and collaboration, helping individuals to develop better social skills and become more comfortable interacting with others.

Sense of community:

The ballroom dance community is generally welcoming and supportive, fostering a sense of belonging and camaraderie among its members.

Opportunities for connection:

Dancing with a partner can create a unique bond and connection, strengthening relationships and fostering trust and understanding between partners.

Enhances teamwork:

Learning and performing a ballroom dance routine with a partner or a group requires cooperation, coordination, and mutual support, promoting teamwork and collaboration skills.



DIFFERENT TYPES

Cha Cha (Latin)

A continual, flirtatious game of “cat and mouse” - the International Cha Cha has Cuban roots, and is known for its breaking action on count “2” and syncopated action on counts 4&1 (also counted as “cha cha cha”).

Samba (Latin)

The Samba is a ballroom dance is inspired by the Brazilian carnival dances. Samba is notably a “bouncy” dance, known for intricate combinations of timings and beat values.

Rumba (Latin)

It showcases alternating timings to depict fast moments within a slow dance. Known as the dance of love, the Rumba is crowd favorite, often telling a romantic story between two people.

Outfit Description

Cha Cha (Latin)

Cha-cha-cha dancers wear a dress with ruffles on it with bright colors. Their shoes are usually the same color as the dress and they are high high heels. Men used to wear ruffles on the bottom of their dresses and on their sleeves. Now they wear a black shirt and black pants that are silky or maybe a white top.

Samba (Latin)

These costumes feature pleated, layered and sequined skirts. Some have slits, some don't, and it is customary to wear a leotard under the skirt, as well as a top to resemble monokinis. The outfit is paired with headgear, as well as boas, fringes, feathers, and beads.

Rumba (Latin)

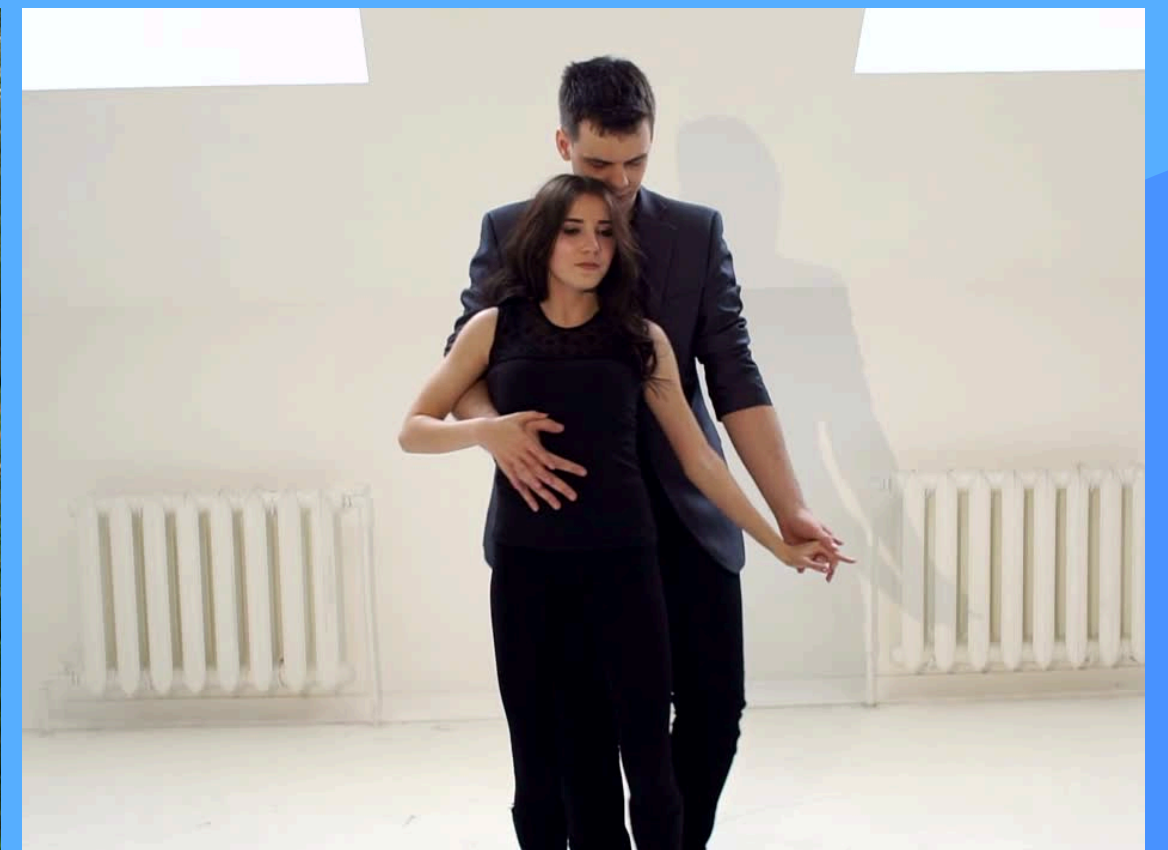
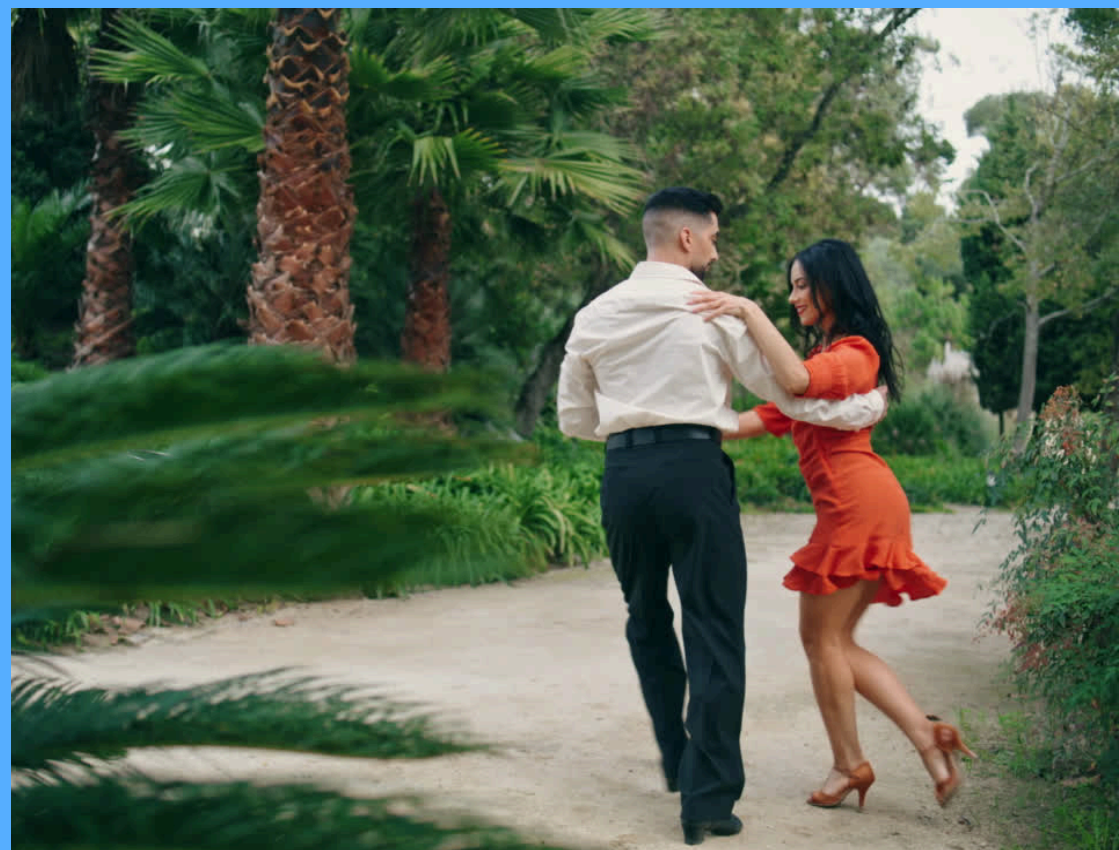
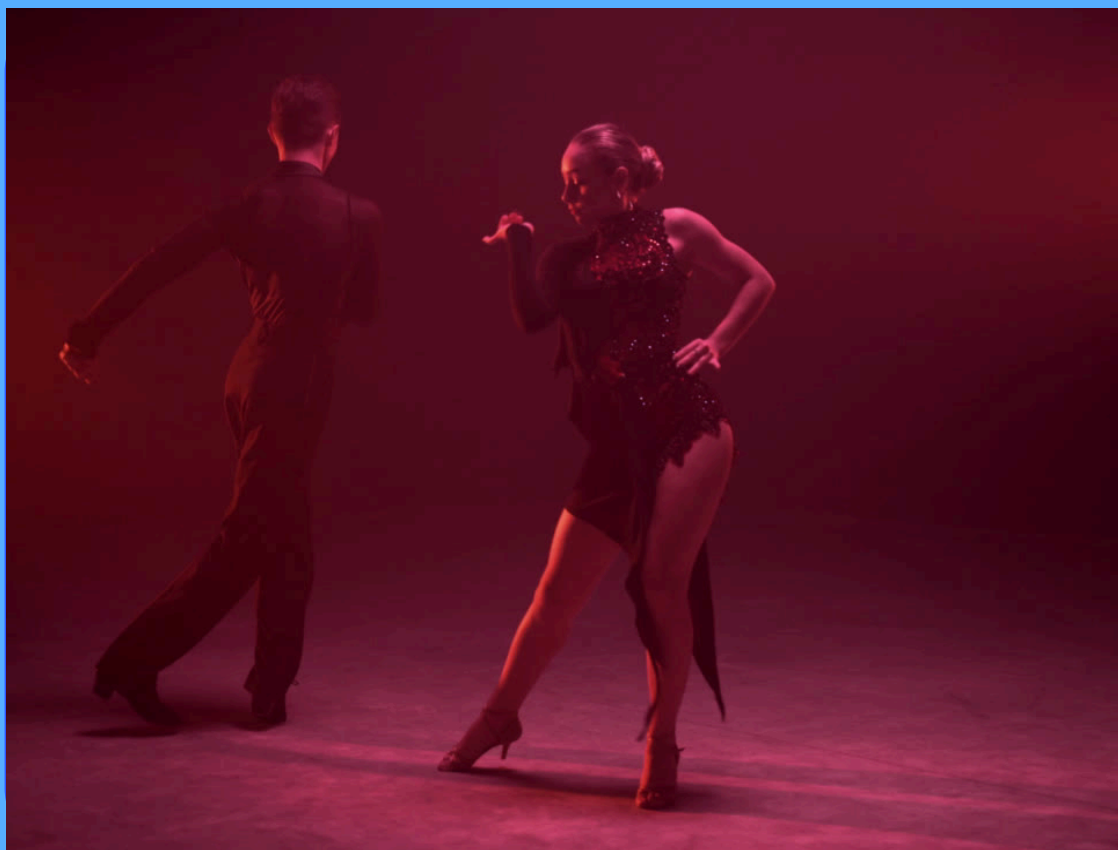
For this reason, your dress should be revealing, but delicately and tastefully. The fluid movement of this type of dance asks for skin-tight outfits or dresses that wrap and hang around your body (consider silk).

Outfit



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Example



DIFFERENT TYPES

Paso Doble (Latin).

A captivating dance style, the Paso Doble is based on the story of the Spanish Bullfight, with partners encapsulating the personalities of the Spanish Bullfighter (Matador) and either a Matador's Cape or Spanish Dancer.

Jive (Latin).

The Jive is a dance built from multiple styles of Swing: East Coast, West Coast, Lindy Hop, Jitterbug, and more. Characterized by quick feet and fun tricks, the Jive often has a crowd on their feet cheering.

Waltz (Ballroom).

The classic, elegant, International Waltz is the quintessential, “ballroom dance” Known for its characteristic “123,” the Waltz is danced in a closed hold (partners do not break their frame and remain connected) from start to finish.

Outfit Description

Paso Doble (Latin)

Traditional Paso Doble outfits for the male dancer consist of the matador pants and a suitable bolero jacket. The outfit is completed with a white shirt and tie. The traditional female outfit usually is red to represent the cape and consists of a long and wide skirt.

Jive (Latin)

Casual partner outfits to local dances but often dress up in matching costumes featuring ballroom dance shoes and formal dresses for professional competitions.

Waltz (Ballroom)

The gown may be one piece or a two-piece ensemble. And even a simple, yet elegant dress of fine chiffon looks marvelous in the ballroom. Full or flared skirts are ideal for waltzing. Tasteful prints and patterns of fine fabric may be worn.

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Outfit



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Example



DIFFERENT TYPES

Tango (Ballroom).

The fiery and passionate Tango features staccato actions and powerful leg movements. Dancers do not have “body rise” within this dance, so it appears flatter and more linear across the dance floor.

Viennese Waltz (Ballroom).

The Viennese Waltz is only comprised of seven figures, therefore dancers spend a lot of time focusing on the creation of the same full, voluminous movements that seem to race around the dance floor.

Foxtrot (Ballroom).

Intricate rise and falls are created by decisive footwork that anecdotally awarded Foxtrot the title of the most difficult Ballroom dance.

DIFFERENT TYPES

Tango (Ballroom)

Tango dresses often have asymmetrical hemlines and many of them with various adornments on fringes and crochet. Most dresses have open tops that show cleavage.

Viennese Waltz (Ballroom)

Most men choose to wear tuxes, suits and ties, or dinner jackets. Most women wear long gowns or cocktail dresses. We suggest that ladies' dresses clear the floor by 2-3 inches to avoid tripping during the peppy Viennese turning waltzes.

Foxtrot (Ballroom)

women normally have long sweeping sleeves or skirts, to help elongate the moves of the dancers, making the dance look smoother. The bodice is a tighter fit, with the skirt flaring out at the waist, the costumes normally have floor length skirts, but on the rare occasion may fall a bit shorter.

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Outfit



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Example



DIFFERENT TYPES

Quickstep (Ballroom).

Leaps, kicks, and running down the floor, all while being connected to another person? In the Quickstep, dancers seem to play Tetris while dancing and navigating in and out of "traffic" on the floor.

Outfit Description

Quickstep (Ballroom).

Traditionally the dancers would wear classic ballroom costumes, but a lady may wear floating panels or a layered skirt because the movement adds emphasis to the dancer's legs and the speed of her movements.

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Outfit



Example



THANK

YOU